

A
HUNTING ALPHABET

BY

GRACE CLARKE NEWTON

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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE A B C OF DRAG
HUNTING ***

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BY
GRACE CLARKE NEWTON

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GRACE CLARKE NEWTON

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A HUNTING ALPHABET

Illustrated

THE
A B C
OF
DRAG HUNTING
BY
GRACE CLARKE NEWTON

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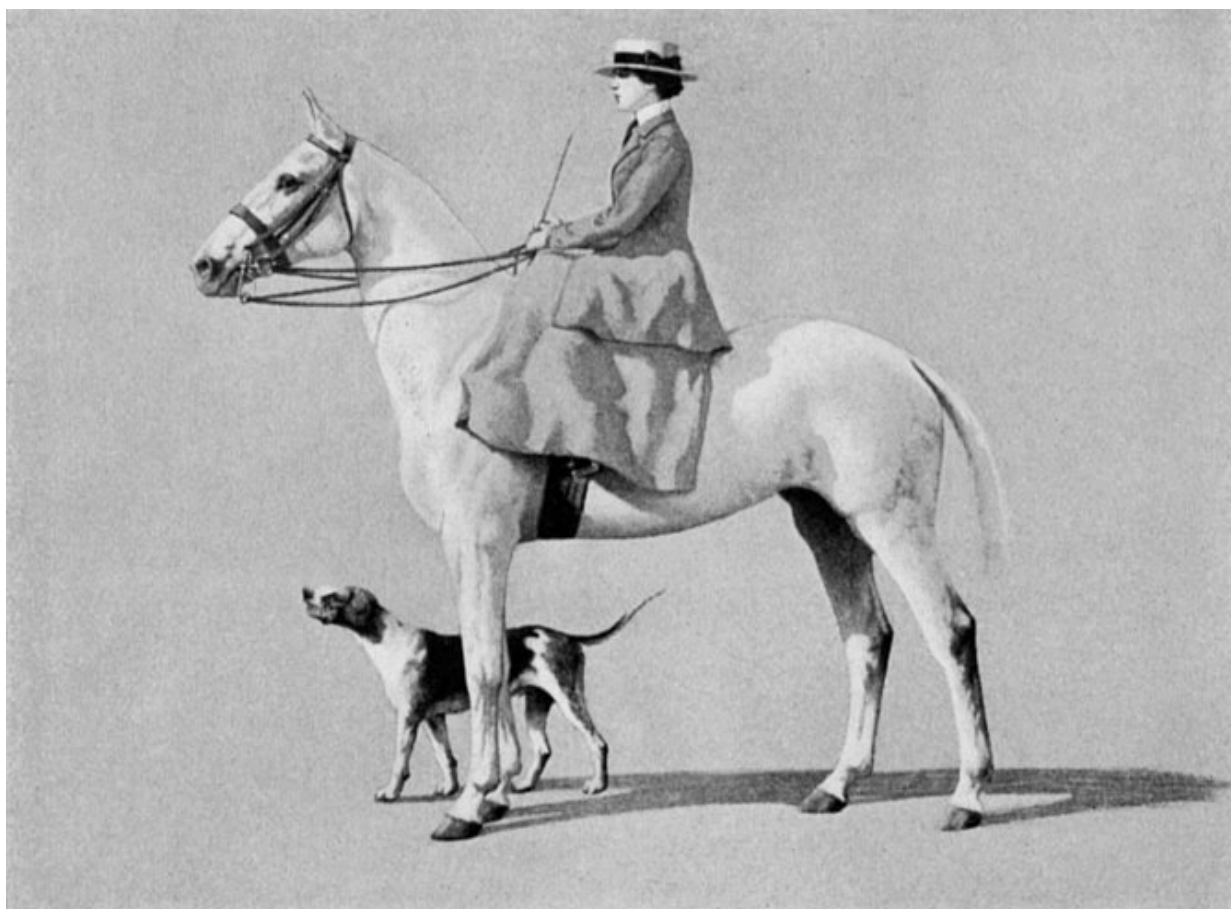
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The illustrations are from some paintings by

RICHARD NEWTON, JR.



MRS. E. T. COCKCROFT—AND “DANGER”



A is Ambition which leads you to buy
A qualified hunter, the picture of pride,
Of whom it is said, "He takes off in his stride."
This means he jumps you off with hounds in full
cry.



B is the Beauty who's learning to "go,"
Who comes to the Club on the morn of the Meet,
And says to the Master, "Now if you'll be sweet
And let me ride near you, I'll finish I know!"



BENJAMIN NICOLL, ESQ.—ESSEX HUNT (ON COCKTAIL)



C is the Casualty frequently met
When a Ditch next a creeper-clad fence lies
concealed;
Also the Comments of most of the field,
“For the man who lays drags with a butterfly
net!”



D is the overworked letter so Dear
To the heart of the Sportsman who's riding a skate,
Who thinks there is no one to open the gate
And fails to observe that the Vicar stands near.



JOHN R. TOWNSEND, ESQ., M. F. H.—ORANGE CO. HUNT (ON GREEK DOLLAR)



E is your Epitaph, writ by a wag,
Which reached you by post on your first
 hunting morn;
“Hic jacet! He hoped to be pride of the Quorn
But died of sheer fright ere he rode in one
 drag.”



F is the Fence “made of stout posts and rails
Five feet”! You “*sailed* over it riding the grey”;
But do not dine out on it often, I pray,
For at each repetition the interest pales.



J. E. DAVIS, ESQ., M. F. H.—MEADOWBROOK HUNT



G is the Gathering Gloom of Her Grace,
The Great One, invited to open our Ball,
When she heard that the Master had had a bad fall
And the Honorable Whip is to fill in his place.



H is the Horn of the Huntsman that sounds
Rather wheezy and thin to irreverent ears;
But Ah! 'tis a music melodic, which cheers
The Hearts of the nailers who follow Hounds.



I is the Impulse by which you are curst;
To prove you have courage when fox hounds
are “Cast,”
“I’ll jam in my spurs and be after them fast,”
It seems that the Master prefers to go first.



DRAWN BLANK



J is the Jackrabbit, running so free,
And the Jar to the Master who sees that his pack
Have tacitly told him they cannot come back
'Til the last of their fat furry friend they can see.



K is the Kennels where foxhounds are kept,
A visit to these is a part of the Game;
'Tis a wise M. F. H. knows each couple by
name,
But when *they* know *him* they say strong men
have wept.



L is for “Larking” to try out a colt;
How lightly he leaps from the paddock or pen,
But, once on his back it’s a question of when
He will lie down or roll on you, buck, jump or
bolt.



A FEW OF THE RIGHT SORT



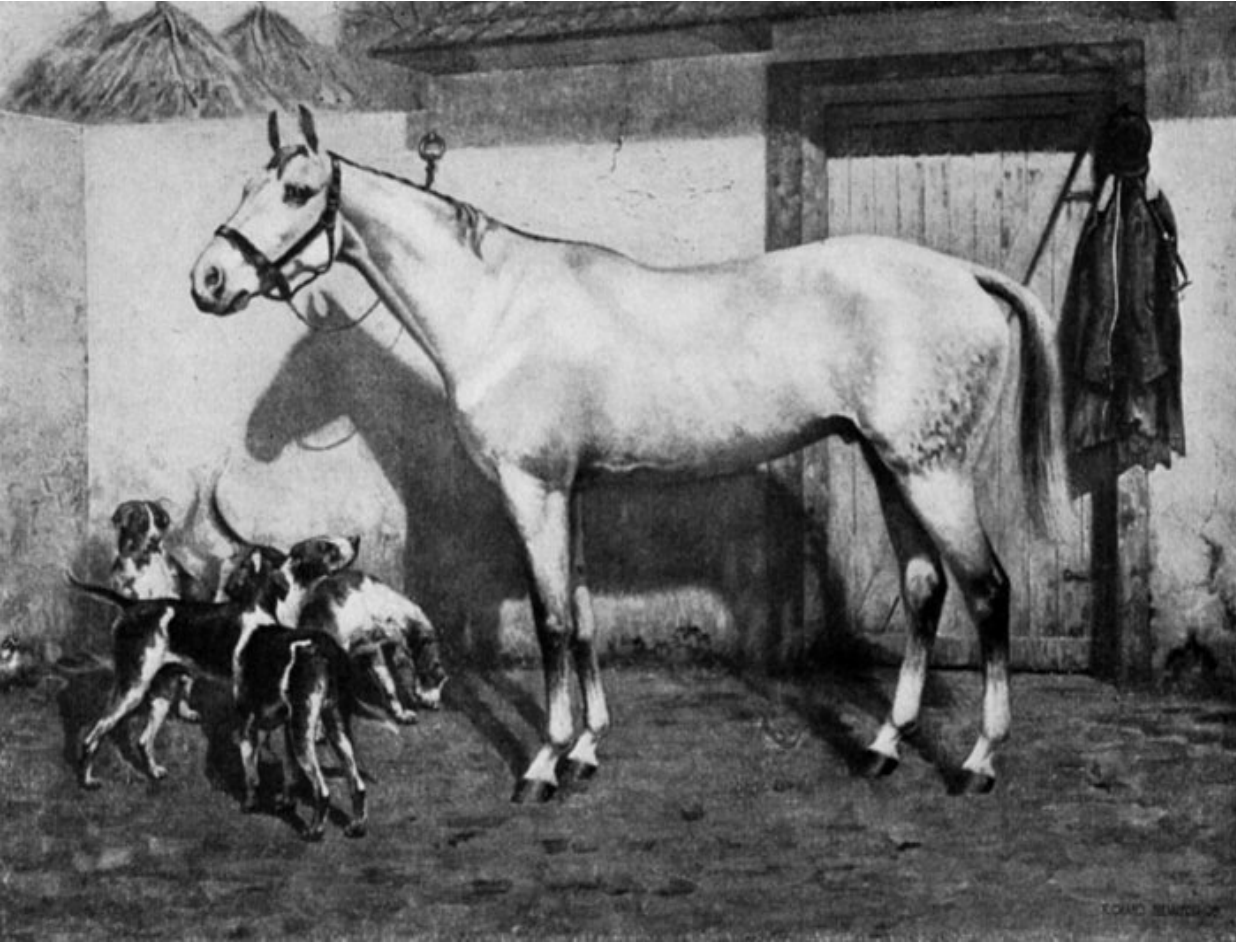
M is the Merriment seen on each face,
At the rumor some hunting man offers to sell
“The *pick* of the stable, because he can’t tell
If he’s going abroad for a season to race.”



N is the Nag, “Nervy Nat,” who was lent
For your use by a friend when your own
horse broke down,
And the News, that was sent to your dear
ones in Town,
“Some bones have been broken and some are
just bent.”



O is the Opportune Offer you made
To carry a flask in case of a spill;
Then you learn that it's equally good for a chill
And most of the field of a chill are afraid.



A HUNTING MORN



P is for “Pink,” to its pomp we aspire
When riding in “mufti”; but how do we feel
When bound for the Meet, quite the modern
John Peel,
If village boys shout, “Oh, I say, where’s the
fire?”



Q is the Quagmire where you get stuck
And the Quizzical Questions of those on the
bank,
Who, as they help you to rescue your horse
on a plank,
“Were you hunting a fox or just chasing a
duck?”



R is The Road that the faint-hearted choose
When the line crosses country where going is
risky:
And the Rot that they talk, as they sip their Scotch
Whiskey.
To prove it's not they, but their mounts that refuse.



MAJOR W. AUSTIN WADSWORTH, M. F. H.—GENESE HOUNDS



S is the Scent, none too pleasant to those
Who ride not to hounds; but at swift hunting pace,
When the Right Sort detect it, how madly they
 race;
They find it more sweet than the breath of a rose.



T is for Thousands, the cost of our fun,
Also for the Thrusters and they are not few
Who send in a “ten” when the season is through
It pays for the timber they broke in one run.



U is for Us when united we fight
That the skirt called “divided” be worn by the Fair;
If you’ve seen a dear girl with her boots in the air
As she lands in a furrow, you’ll say I am right.



THE GREY HUNT TEAM—SUFFOLK HOUNDS



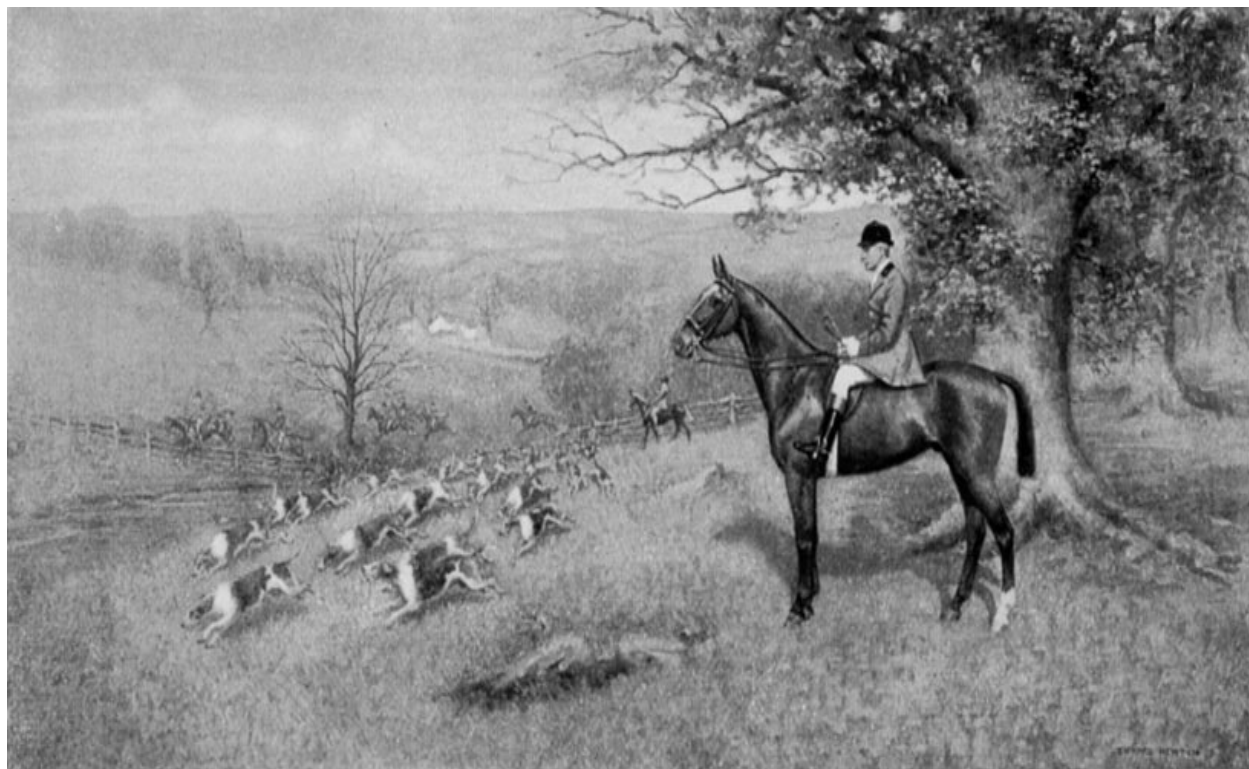
V is the Viewpoint of those who are vexed,
By the Master's great promptness when they
ride up late;
“Confounded old Martinet, couldn't he wait?
Cast hounds by alarm clock, that's what he'll
do next.”



W stands for the Week-end so wet
We spent with our friend of a neighboring
 hunt,
You could keep up with hounds if you went in
 a “punt”
But I need not tell you how far we *did* get.



X is for Crossroads and sign posts galore;
You shout the Bumpkin who's raking his hay,
"Which way went the pack?" and his "Well, I
can't say;
Ain't seen any peddlers!" is rather a bore.



OAKLEIGH THORNE ESQ., M. F. H.—MILLBROOK HARRIERS



Y stands for You who have stood for these rhymes,
Who discern amid chaff shining kernels of truth;
So the spirit of chivalry, valor and youth
Are found in the pleasures and sports of our times.



Z is for Zero—our surplus, my dear,
When, after good sport with all damages paid,
We sit by the fire and say, “I’m afraid
There’ll be no more runs till the Spring of the
year.”

And here ends this volume of A HUNTING ALPHABET, by Grace Clarke Newton, of which 262 copies only have been printed by Redfield-Kendrick-Odell Co., Inc., New York, and the type distributed, in this year of our Lord one thousand nine hundred and seventeen.

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